

Día de los Muertos Ceremony

Honoring Our Ancestors Through Ceremony, Danza, and Community.

(banner picture)

Picture link : <https://photos.app.goo.gl/4SNW2pAm4QA4ksHN8>



ABOUT THE CEREMONY

Día de los Muertos is a sacred tradition centered on honoring and remembering our ancestors and loved ones who have passed. This practice includes the creation of an ofrenda, or altar, adorned with symbolic elements such as cempasúchil (marigold flowers), candles, and the favorite foods and beverages of those being remembered. Through these offerings, we welcome their spirit back to be with us in a meaningful and celebratory way.

Kalpulli Ehecatl hosts an annual Día de los Muertos ceremony in Watsonville, California. This public gathering brings together community members and danza groups from across the region to share in prayer, movement, and remembrance. Through danza and ceremony, we honor the lives of our ancestors while keeping our traditions alive.

EVENT RECAP

This year for our 2nd annual 2025 Día De Los Muertos ceremony we were blessed with approximately 200 attendees. In attendance we had 5 sauhmadoras / malintzines (fire keepers), 5 atecocollis (conch shell players), 14 huehuets (drummers), 40 group representatives.

IMPORTANT ELEMENTS

(Altar picture)



Arch: The arch in our ceremony represents the horizon sky. The warm tones of orange and red reflect the transition from day into night. Flowers and adornments symbolize the stars, representing the natural cycle of life and death

Altar: Our altar is composed of essential elements that help us honor and connect with our ancestors. Each item carries symbolic meaning and serves to welcome their spirit.

Candles - The light of the candles guides our loved ones back to us, illuminating their path.

Cempasúchil - Known in Nahuatl as cempowalxochitl, meaning “twenty flowers,” these bright orange petals and their strong scent guide spirits home.

Petate - A traditional woven mat that symbolizes rest, life, and death, and the connection between the physical and spiritual worlds.

Tamales - Tamales represent the human body and our connection to maize. Many Indigenous cultures refer to themselves as hijos de maíz—children of corn—reflecting the deep relationship between identity, sustenance, and the earth.

DONORS

We are incredibly grateful for the overwhelming support that made this event possible. Members of our community contributed countless hours, resources, and energy to bring this ceremony to life.



We also extend our appreciation to local businesses and organizations whose donations supported key elements such as the altar, community spaces, and shared meals.

Special thanks to Adela Naranjo for her generous contribution as a community member

MOMENTS FROM THE CEREMONY

PHOTO CREDIT - Jorge Tlac Orozco

Explore photographs capturing moments of prayer, danza, community and remembrance throughout the ceremony.

PICTURE LINKS:

<https://photos.app.goo.gl/NviYKtpVRGbJyrci7>

<https://photos.app.goo.gl/Ust4LH7KkmrFqUFD9>

<https://photos.app.goo.gl/6tr29RrWJ8yEKpxp6>

<https://photos.app.goo.gl/X1AY4jjqrXotAoLz5>

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